

If It All Falls Apart

Total-failure scenarios only. Everything smaller is on the Troubleshooting Card.

None of these have happened yet, and probably won't. This page exists so that if one does, you have a plan already written down instead of having to invent one live, in front of a room, while stressed. That's the whole point of it.

Wifi or internet dies completely

Nobody's Codespace will load or save. This is genuinely rare, but total.

"Right — the internet's had other ideas. Grab a pen and paper. We're doing this the old way for a bit: sketch your fix or your feature idea on paper, in as much detail as you can, and we'll type it in the moment we're back online."

Use the downtime for something that doesn't need a connection: the brainstorm, the planning questions, or just talking through what a bug or feature should do in plain English.

GitHub or Codespaces itself is down

Rare, but does happen occasionally — check githubstatus.com on your phone if you suspect this (it'll load even if Codespaces won't).

"This one isn't us — GitHub's having a moment. Let's not fight it. While we wait, let's do [brainstorm / planning / a walkthrough on my screen] instead."

Your own screen, shared on the projector, becomes the whole room's workspace. Take suggestions verbally, type them yourself. Slower, but it still works, and it's actually a fun format for a short stretch.

Projector or your laptop dies

Nobody can see what you're demonstrating.

"Screen's down — gather round for a minute." Physically bring students closer to whatever screen still works, or narrate what you'd be showing them and let them follow along on their own screens instead.



You're badly behind schedule

More than 15 minutes lost somewhere and it's compounding.

"New plan, and it's a good one: everyone's target is now [the next milestone only]. Stretch goals are for another day." Cut scope out loud, with confidence — never apologise for cutting, just announce the new target plainly.

The single easiest cut: shorten Feature Creation, keep Show & Tell no matter what. Ending with demos matters more than finishing every feature.



You genuinely don't know what to do next

The moment every facilitator has at some point.

"Give me one second." Look at this page, or the Troubleshooting Card, or just ask the room: "What does everyone think we should do here?" Teenagers often have a perfectly good answer, and asking them is a completely legitimate move, not a failure.

Whatever happens, the day doesn't need to be perfect to work. It needs Show & Tell to happen at the end. Protect that above everything else.